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Democracy Dies in Darkness

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026 · **$4**

Nvidia CEO affair may pose a peril to economy

Company has helped propel the AI boom that has buoyed Wall Street

BY IAN DUNCAN, NITASHA TIKU AND CAT ZAKRZEWSKI

It took more than 30 years for Nvidia chief executive Jensen Huang to grow his start-up from a minnow of the video game industry to one of the world's most valuable companies.

His signature leather jacket, frequent media appearances and close relationship with President Donald Trump made Huang one of the most iconic CEOs of the artificial intelligence era, providing computer chips and financing that have helped sustain an economic boom that has lifted millions of investment and retirement accounts. He helped reshape U.S. policy toward China.

Now Huang faces a crisis after he admitted Sunday to an affair with a woman who is a technology executive alleged to have been a Chinese spy. Trump said Monday that he had spoken with Huang and believed the CEO's assurances that he did not know the woman, Alice Huang, was a spy. Nvidia's board is investigating the matter and lawmakers from both major parties are calling for congressional probes into Huang's conduct.

At stake is not just the CEO's position at Nvidia but potentially the fate of the AI economy and U.S. relations with China as the two nations compete over the future of artificial intelligence.

SEE **NVIDIA** ON **A14**

Alleged Chinese spy: The phantom life of Alice Huang. **A11**
Silicon Valley: Sector's espionage problem has deep roots. **A11**



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Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth defends his record and the Iran war at a Pentagon news briefing Tuesday. He sought to reframe the allegations against him, saying they were "not about me" but rather an attack on the president and rank-and-file military personnel.

Republicans block Hegseth impeachment effort

Narrow vote sidelines the Massie measure in a display of party unity after last week's midterm drubbing

BY TARA COPP, DAN LAMOTHE AND NOAH ROBERTSON

The House on Tuesday narrowly staved off an effort to impeach Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, temporarily easing the political pressure facing President Donald Trump and his polarizing Pentagon chief.

By a 211-204 vote, lawmakers referred the impeachment articles to a committee for further study, effectively sidelining the measures. Had the effort advanced, lawmakers would have held final votes Wednesday.

The result follows a coordinated effort within the Trump administration — including by Trump himself — to defend Hegseth. The secretary held a rare Pentagon news conference Tuesday during which he attacked the impeachment push and appealed directly to the president and his allies in Congress.

Rep. Thomas Massie (Kentucky), a fellow Republican and frequent critic of Trump, led the impeachment effort, which focused on the Iran war and Hegseth's controversial leadership of the Pentagon.

The vote displayed GOP unity following the party's midterm losses last week. Enough Republicans showed up to defend Hegseth, and only Massie supported the effort.

In a social media post after the vote, Trump attacked Massie and celebrated the result as an "EXONERATION of a Great American Patriot," referring to Hegseth.

Massie told reporters after the vote: "We put the question to Congress. What I found out tonight is they still haven't broken from the spell of Donald Trump. He still controls this conference."

While Hegseth survived Tuesday's vote, he emerged facing more outspoken GOP criticism of his tenure than ever before during his two years as defense secretary.

Multiple Republicans who opposed the impeachment still said they were unhappy with Hegseth, and some GOP senators indicated they would have been open to holding a trial had the impeachment advanced.

Democrats, who beginning in January will hold sizable majorities in both chambers of Congress, have said they will seek to use their newfound power to remove Hegseth from office.

SEE **HEGSETH** ON **A8**

Jordan picked to lead GOP in House

IN SENATE, PARTY STICKS WITH THUNE

Ohio lawmaker pledges to fight Democratic probes

BY MARIANA ALFARO AND THEODORIC MEYER

Republicans on Tuesday elected Rep. Jim Jordan (Ohio) as minority leader for the next Congress, in which the party's ranks will be severely diminished after last week's midterm elections.

Senate Republicans opted to stick with Senate Majority Leader John Thune (South Dakota), who did not face a challenger and will become minority leader in January.

Jordan defeated a longtime rival, House Majority Leader Steve Scalise (R-Louisiana), in a competitive race for the job. The two have been jockeying for leadership positions for more than a decade, and both unsuccessfully tried to become speaker in 2023.

Jordan, chairman of the House Judiciary Committee, promised colleagues that he would mount an aggressive defense against the many investigations House Democrats have said they will launch into President Donald Trump, his family and his administration after the next Congress is sworn in in January.

Jordan prevailed 106-73 on a secret ballot in the closed-door vote, while Majority Whip Tom Emmer (R-Minnesota) secured a tally of 103-76, according to several lawmakers and aides, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to share a vote total that

SEE **REPUBLICANS** ON **A7**

Democrats: Progressive activists aim to block Jeffries, Schumer. **A4**

ICE recruits named in DHS hack landed jobs despite red flags

At least 19 officers hired were involved in past misconduct, files reveal

This article is by Ted Hesson, Joyce Sohyun Lee, Razzan Nakhlawi, Maria Sacchetti and Aaron Schaffer

One officer in Detroit fired multiple shots at a fleeing teenage suspect, fatally striking him in the back in an incident that led to a $2.5 million settlement with his family.

An Arkansas officer was castigated by his supervisor for showing "unreasonable anger" while on the job, and fired after his boss expressed concern about what he might do "when he faces a civilian who he feels has disrespected him."

Some officers went viral for embarrassing incidents, including a New York City detective who stole nearly $3,000 worth of high-end champagne at a music festival and a Mississippi officer who said under oath that he couldn't remember core rights bestowed by the U.S. Constitution.

All of them share one thing in common: They were later hired as federal immigration officers to carry out President Donald Trump's mass deportation campaign.

The Trump administration has onboarded thousands of new officers in an accelerated recruitment effort that has bypassed traditional background checks in favor of quickly putting people onto the streets to arrest undocumented immigrants. In recent months, at least two of those hires were involved in shootings, including one that resulted in the death of a 25-year-old Colombian father. Some have been fired after U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement discovered red flags in their backgrounds that initially went undetected.

The names of the officers hired to scour residential streets, courthouses and airports have been shielded by the Department of Homeland Security, which cites privacy policies designed to protect them from harassment, even in incidents where they are involved in fatal use of force.

But that cloak of anonymity was pierced in late October when activists hacked a DHS employee database and released information about thousands of workers, including about 1,500 ICE officers and agents hired since Trump took office in 2025. The Washington Post performed

SEE **DHS** ON **A9**



SEAN RAYFORD/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

South Carolina Democrats celebrate Friday at the 41st NAACP Freedom Fund Banquet in Sumter.

Upset in red S.C. delights Democrats

BY IAN WARD

COLUMBIA, S.C. — The headquarters of the South Carolina Democratic Party is housed in a squat one-story building on the outskirts of downtown Columbia, in a sleepy residential neighborhood near the governor's mansion. The brick building's modest proportions reflect the state party's historically humble fortunes: Until recently, a Democrat had not been elected to statewide office in South Carolina in nearly two decades. The last Democratic presidential nominee to win the state was Jimmy Carter in 1976.

Last week, though, the party headquarters became the center of a stunning Democratic upset when Annie Andrews prevailed over Darline Graham in the state's U.S. Senate election. Andrews's victory broke Republicans' decades-long hold on the seat and helped propel Democrats to an unlikely majority in the Senate. Meanwhile, at the headquarters of the state Democratic Party, the surprise success prompted a once-unthinkable question: Ahead of the state's first-in-the-nation presidential primary in 2028, can South Carolina Democrats turn their state from red to purple?

Signs of post-midterms merriment were evident Thursday afternoon at the headquarters, where piles of yard signs and half-eaten containers of takeout littered the labyrinth of low-ceil-

SEE **SOUTH CAROLINA** ON **A6**

U.S. agencies' power to levy fines weighed at high court

The conservative majority has been paring back the tools of federal regulators

BY LAURA BEVERIDGE AND JULIAN MARK

The Supreme Court on Tuesday grappled with arguments about whether federal labor regulators can directly impose hundreds of thousands of dollars in fines on a New Jersey farm they allege mistreated workers.

The case before the justices could have far-reaching consequences for the power of federal agencies to enforce labor laws. The high court's conservative majority has pared back the power of federal regulators in a series of recent cases.

In 2015, the Department of Labor accused Sun Valley Orchards, a family farm in New Jersey, of failing to provide adequate working and living conditions for its immigrant laborers who had been brought into the United States under the H-2A visa program. According to the department, Sun Valley did not provide the workers with adequate meals and they had to use

SEE **SUPREME COURT** ON **A2**

IN THE NEWS

D.C. Council Jamal Holtz, 28, was sworn in as the city's first Gen Z lawmaker, but Democrats made clear that the purpose of his appointment was to serve only as a placeholder. **B13**

Washington National Cathedral The final and toughest phase of restoration work — the central tower — is underway. **B13**

THE NATION
A GOP House member is accused of "extravagant" travel expenses in an investigation. A4
An appeals court ruled that VOA's director was fired illegally by former head Kari Lake. A5

THE WORLD
Delegations from Russia and Ukraine opened U.S.-backed peace talks in Abu Dhabi. A10
Several U.S. military aircraft abruptly departed a second military base in England. A10

THE ECONOMY
The pace of inflation eased on a monthly basis in October as households saw some relief from gas prices' steep climb, but food prices picked up. A12
Anthropic is aiming for its IPO to value the company at more than $1 trillion. A13

STYLE
The Mall was meant for peace but instead is getting crowded with war memorials, Philip Kennicott writes. B1

SPORTS
The Vikings reacquired NFL quarterback Kirk Cousins in an attempt to revive their sputtering offense. B7

THE REGION
Drones are set to fly through D.C.'s normally restricted skies this week in a test of detection technology. B13

FOOD
Cooking mistakes are easy to make, but you can still turn your slipups in the kitchen into something tasty.

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